

Office: Koury Business Center (KoBC) 118	Class: Sankey 104, TU/TH 10:30 AM – 12:10 PM
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Course Goals

This course will provide an introduction to the principles of economics, during which you will:

1. Learn how people, businesses, and governments make decisions in the context of limited resources.
2. Understand how markets work (and, sometimes, don't work) using a supply and demand framework.
3. Understand how and why trade occurs, as well as how it affects our lives.
4. Learn how to quantify the health of the economy (e.g., GDP, unemployment rate, inflation), what causes economic ups and downs, and how policy can promote growth.

The economic tools that you will acquire in this course are applied by managers in the business sector, policymakers in government roles, and researchers in the academic arena. Upon successfully completing this course, you should have an understanding of these basic economic principles and their applicability to real world situations. You should also be able to incorporate the tools of economic analysis into your own decision-making processes as you weigh costs and benefits to make choices in your personal and professional life.

Course Materials

Readings for the course will be taken from a variety of sources, but the **main thing you need** is access to **Achieve**. This is an online learning platform that includes access to our textbook (*Principles of Economics* (2nd edition), by Betsey Stevenson and Justin Wolfers, ISBN: 9781319449995). You should be able to access it through our Canvas course page and, because this course participates in the “[First Day](#)” program, your student account will be automatically charged directly on top of your tuition with the Bursar's Office. This includes access to an e-textbook and online homework system.

Canvas

We will be using Canvas frequently. I will post relevant course materials and your grades here. It is essential that you check this resource, *along with your Elon email*, regularly for course updates.

Teaching Philosophy

I believe that teaching is fun and look forward to interacting with each of you throughout the semester about economics and any other concerns you may have. I strongly believe that “learning by doing” is the best way for students to learn, so class time will be a mixture of lecture and active learning. Some people (maybe even you!) have preconceived notions that economics is boring – better known as the “dismal science.” I intend to prove otherwise by going beyond simple lectures of the material and showing how economics can be applied to everyday life. The goal of this class is not only to teach you specific concepts and techniques, but also to teach you to **think critically**. This is a vital skill to have as you venture through life.

Grading System

Your final grade for the course is based on the standard grade distribution: A 93 to 100, A- 90 to 92.99, B+ 87 to 89.99, B 83 to 86.99, B- 80 to 82.99, C+ 77 to 79.99, C 73 to 76.99, C- 70 to 72.99, D+ 67 to 69.99, D 63 to 66.99, D- 60 to 62.99, F below 60 percent.

Task	% of Course Grade
Attendance & Participation	5%
Learning Curve	5%
Homework	10%
Team-Based Learning	20%
Exam One	20%
Exam Two	20%
Final Exam	20%

Exams

You will have 3 opportunities to showcase your learning (also known as exams). *Each exam* will be cumulative, which will provide you with an opportunity to demonstrate learning throughout the semester and improve upon your course grade. If you perform better on a later exam, then that score will replace your previous score(s). For example, if you earn a 75% on the first exam, and then earn an 80% on the second exam, then the 80% replaces your first exam score. If you then get a 90% on the final exam, then that score replaces *both* of your previous scores.¹ The exams may cover material from class, the text, and any assigned outside material. Each exam will consist of short-answer/essays, problems that require some mathematical calculation and/or graphical depiction, as well as some multiple choice questions. No make-up exams will be given. If you miss one of the first two exams, then I will move the weight of that exam to the next exam. There are no alternatives for the final exam, so please be sure to prioritize the date/time below. The dates for the exams are:

Exam 1: Thursday, September 24th

Exam 2: Thursday, October 29th

Final Exam: Wednesday, December 10th, 1 – 4 PM

Team-Based Learning

An important component of this course will be team-based learning (TBL). For this, I will place you into teams of 3 or 4 people and this will be your team for the entire semester. Team activities will only take place during class time, so you do not have to worry about organizing meetings outside of class (although your teammates might be a helpful study group). The TBL activities will include individual readiness assessment tests (iRAT), team readiness assessment tests (tRAT), application exercises (AE), and a peer review (at the end of the semester). The iRAT's and tRAT's will consist of 5 multiple-choice questions that are intended to highlight important concepts we are learning and ensure you have the foundation to complete the application exercise for that day. The application exercise is where you practice applying concepts from the chapter. Overall, we will do 6-10 TBL's throughout

¹Note: This only works backwards, not forwards. For example, earning a 95% on the first exam does not prevent you from earning a lower score on future exams.

the semester and they will take place in the first half of class, with the iRAT starting at the beginning of class time. Your grade for this portion of the course will be determined by your performance on the iRAT's, tRAT's, AE's, and a peer evaluation completed near the end of the semester. We will decide as a class how to allocate the 15 percentage points across most categories. Application Exercises will be worth 2 percentage points (of the total 15) and will be based on turning something in at the end of the TBL. The remaining point allocation will be decided after completing at least 2 TBL's, so that you can decide as a class what you think will be most beneficial. Points can be allocated as follows:

	Possible	Chosen
iRAT's	$\geq 3\%$	
tRAT's	$\geq 3\%$	
Application Exercises	2%	2%
Peer Review	$\geq 3\%$	
Total	20%	20%

Homework

These assignments are available through Achieve and we will have one for each chapter that we cover. You will be able to drop your lowest homework grade with no questions asked. The assignments are meant to challenge you and enhance your ability to apply the concepts we learn in class. You are allowed unlimited attempts on the homework questions until the due date, after which there will be a penalty for late submission. Be sure not to wait until right before the due date to start the assignments so you can avoid a late submission.

Learning Curve

This is available through Achieve and it is designed to improve your success in this course. The *Learning Curve* questions are meant to improve your ability to learn *and* retain information. If you approach the questions with sincerity and honest effort, then it will help you learn the material and identify your weaknesses, so that you can efficiently use your study time. You will find they will help you prepare for class. It also gives you a starting point when asking me for help whenever you struggle with any of the material. You are able to try these as many times as you wish without penalty prior to the due date, so make sure to complete them on time.

Attendance & Participation

Attendance: It is important that you attend class regularly because you do not want to miss out on notes or discussions with peers and we will do many in-class activities. To incentivize you to show up and participate in class, you will receive points simply for showing up. Attendance will be worth 5 points per class. I will drop 4 of these scores with no questions asked. If you have to miss class, please be sure to get notes from a classmate, check Moodle for any practice problems, and go to drop-in hours with questions.

Participation: This portion of the grade will be based on questions posted to Moodle. Fully answering the questions will get you 10 points. If you submit something but do not put forth adequate effort in answering the questions, you will receive 5 points. If you do not submit anything, you will receive 0 points. This is meant to take less than 10 minutes to complete and is intended to help me *and* you measure your progress by reflecting on what we did throughout the week. These assignments will be due by Sunday night but you can submit them anytime after our Thursday classes prior to the Sunday

deadline. This allows me to look through them before we meet on Tuesday and discuss concepts that are confusing or generate some more practice problems.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy

Generative AI is becoming a fixture in society, for better or worse, so it is imperative that we not ignore it. When used appropriately, you may employ AI tools to support your learning in this course. For example, using AI tools to quiz you over course material, prompting AI tools to explain or clarify course concepts, or using AI tools as instructed by your professor for a class activity or assignment are all allowable uses. The *Achieve* homework platform has AI built-in to help you and you are welcome to use it in that circumstance. Other AI platforms could also prove to be useful study tools for you, as long as you are using them correctly (see the Elon guide [here](#)). However, using AI tools in ways that bypass learning is not considered appropriate. Submitting AI generated work as your own, using AI tools to answer questions during exams or assessments when prohibited by your professor, or other similar uses of AI are inappropriate and represent Elon Honor Code violations. If you are uncertain if your use of AI tools is appropriate, ask your professor.

Class Atmosphere

I intend to provide a relaxed, yet structured classroom setting. To this end, please note the following:

Be Prepared. Attending class and reading *beforehand* will be super helpful for you! Trust me on this. At least skim the reading for the big ideas. Jotting down a few notes or questions while you read are even more helpful! During class, please do not hesitate to ask questions. There is no such thing as a stupid question! If you do not feel comfortable asking your question during class, feel free to stop by my drop-in hours (or schedule an appointment) or email me.

Be Courteous. This one should be easy: just be a kind human. I promise I'll do the same. Be nice and welcoming to your classmates because you are all navigating the same challenging course. Also, please show up to class on time so that you don't miss anything at the beginning of class. This is especially important because a large part of this course is built on teamwork. I'll always start class promptly. I understand you may occasionally run late, and that is fine, but we will need to have a conversation if I think it is hurting your success in the class or if it is distracting to your classmates.

Device Policy. You *cannot* use laptops for note-taking and your phones should not be on your desk during class time. You *can* use a tablet, but only if it can lay flat on the desk and the only app you have open is for note-taking. We are living in an ever-distracted world but learning new things requires focus. We also have pretty good research that shows taking notes by hand is more effective than using a laptop (for many reasons, including the fact that people using a laptop often use it to "multitask" rather than focus on the class). We will have dedicated time for device use, including group activities and periodic class breaks. Failure to comply with this policy will reduce your attendance and participation grade and may result in an Honor Code violation.

Disabilities Resources Students with disabilities (physical, learning, psychological, chronic, or temporary medical conditions, etc.) who would like to request reasonable accommodations and services under the Americans with Disabilities Act must register with Disabilities Resources (D.R.) in the KLC/Belk Library, Suite 226. Students who are new to D.R. or who are requesting new accommodations should contact D.R. at (336) 278-6568 or at disabilities@elon.edu to discuss the programs and services offered. Students who are already registered with D.R. and who would like to maintain their accommodations must renew previously granted accommodations

by logging into the [Accommodate site](#) and making a semester request. For more information about D.R., please visit their [website](#). I'm happy to make reasonable accommodations.

Religious Holidays Policies In supporting religious diversity, Elon has a policy and procedures for students who wish to observe religious holidays that are in conflict with the academic calendar, allowing students an excused absence. Students who wish to observe a holiday during the semester must complete the online [Religious Observance Notification Form \(RONF\)](#) within the first two weeks of the semester. This policy does not apply during the final examination period. Students are required to make prior arrangements with the instructor for completion of any work missed during the absence. Once the completed RONF is received, the Truitt Center will confirm the excused absence with notification to the instructor and the appropriate academic dean, along with a copy to the student. Students may contact the Truitt Center staff with any questions (336-278-7729).

Care and Support As members of the Elon community, we each share a personal responsibility to express concern for one another and to ensure that this classroom and the campus as a whole remains a healthy environment for learning. Occasionally, you may become worried or concerned about a fellow classmate's well-being. When this is the case, I would encourage you to share these concerns with me or directly to [Elon's Student Care and Outreach program](#). Although you can report anonymously, it is preferred that you share your contact information so they can follow up with you personally.

Do NOT cheat. Cheating will NOT be tolerated. Refer to [Elon's Honor Code policy](#).

Tentative* Course Outline		
Week	Topic and Notes	Readings
Section 1: Core Foundations		
1 (8/25, 8/27)	Core Principles	Ch. 1
2 (9/1, 9/3)	Trade and Comparative Advantage	Ch. 8
3 (9/8, 9/10)	Demand & Supply	Chs. 2-3
4 (9/15, 9/17)	Equilibrium	Ch. 4
5 (9/22, 9/24)	Exam Review, Thursday: EXAM ONE	
Section 2: Welfare & Role of Government		
6 (9/29, 10/1)	Elasticity, Govt. Intervention	Chs. 5, 6
7 (10/6, 10/8)	Welfare Economics	Ch. 7
8 (10/13, 10/15)	Externalities, Thurs. 10/16: No Class (Fall Break)	Ch. 10
Section 3: Market Structure		
9 (10/20, 10/22)	Market Structure and Power	Ch. 14
10 (10/27, 10/29) ^α	Exam Review, Thursday: EXAM TWO	
Section 4: Big Picture and Policy		
11 (11/3, 11/5)	GDP, Unemployment	Chs. 21, 23
12 (11/10, 11/12)	Inflation, Business Cycles	Chs. 23, 24
13 (11/17, 11/19)	Aggregate Demand and Aggregate Supply	Ch. 33
14 (11/24, 11/26)	NO CLASS - Thanksgiving Week	
15 (12/1, 12/3)	Catch-up and Current Topics; Final Exam Review	Ch. 33
16 (12/9)	FINAL EXAM: Wednesday, December 9th, 1 – 4 PM	

*This outline is subject to change; updates will be given in class.

^α Last day to withdraw with a "W" is Fri., October 30